

1998 ONWARDS

ETHICAL FASHION

The buying decisions made daily by fashion shoppers have the power to create a cleaner, fairer world – this is the point behind the ethical fashion movement, which urges consumers to choose things that are made without exploiting workers and without polluting the environment. Over the past decade big fashion chains have become experts at filling stores with cheap, fun fashion that changes every week. But if clothes are cheap, someone has been paid cheaply to make them, and consumers are more likely to throw them away to make way for new things each season. A report by the Ellen MacArthur Foundation showed that a truckload of clothing is wasted every second across the world, and that the fashion industry does more damage to the environment every year than international flights and shipping. Designers such as Katharine Hamnett and Stella McCartney have committed to ethically produced fashion, and industry groups have taken action to stop the waste. The British Fashion Council, for example, launched a “Positive Fashion” challenge, asking stores and designers to agree to reduce waste and recycle more. Consumers can help by buying recycled or upcycled clothes, buying locally made things, and buying fewer but better quality clothes.



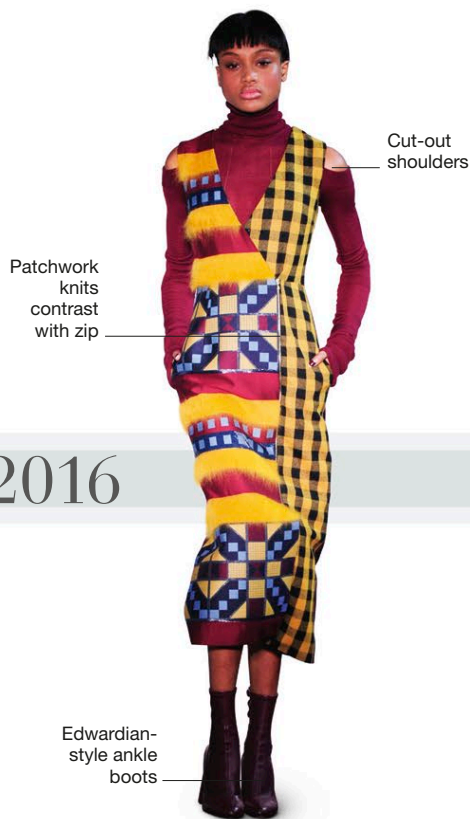
1998

Recycling rules Eco-fashion represents the industry's environmental conscience, emphasizing sustainability in an era of conspicuous consumption. British designer Gary Harvey created this 1998 dress from T-shirts that he recycled from Katharine Hamnett's 1984 collection.

KATHARINE HAMNETT



Famous for her 1980s slogan T-shirts, British designer Katharine Hamnett has built her business on the Buddhist ideal of making a living without harming anyone or anything in the natural world. For example, her T-shirts are made from organic cotton that is grown using rainwater and natural compost from animal droppings. They are made in a factory that uses renewable energy and does not waste power. Since most of her buyers are in Europe, she has her clothes made in Europe, which means less environmental damage caused by transportation too.



2016

Natural wool Catherine Teatum and Rob Jones often work with wool, a natural fibre, for their label Teatum Jones. For Autumn/Winter 2016, they were inspired by an historic wool mill near Teatum's family origins in Ireland, using wools of different textures in lean, Edwardian silhouettes.



2017

Brilliant recycling Christopher Raeburn's graduation show in London in 2006 was a womenswear collection remade from old military uniforms, an idea he reworked for Autumn/Winter 2017. His brand is built on the idea of “Remade, Reduced, Recycled”.